



COLORADO FILM PRODUCTION, VIVO FILM and RAI CINEMA
present

**FOR
THE LOVE
OF A WOMAN**

a film by
GUIDO CHIESA

with
MILI AVITAL
ANA ULARU, ORI PFEFFER, ALBAN UKAJ, MARC RISSMANN
SERHII KYSIL, ANASTASIA DOAGA, SIRA TOPIC, LIMOR GOLDSTEIN

and with
VINCENZO NEMOLATO

with the participation of
MENASHE NOY
and
MONI MOSHONOV

Screenplay by
NICOLETTA MICHELI and GUIDO CHIESA

based on the novel **"THE LOVES OF JUDITH"** by **MEIR SHALEV**

a
COLORADO FILM PRODUCTION and VIVO FILM with RAI CINEMA
production

credits

directed by
screenplay
based on the novel
cinematography
editing
music
sound design
production design
costume design
make-up
hair stylist
production sound
line producer
1st assistant director
casting
in collaboration with
Israel executive prod.
delegate producer
executive producer

produced by
a production
Israel executive prod.
in association with
with the support of
international sales

Country
Year
Length
Language(s)

Guido Chiesa
Nicoletta Micheli and Guido Chiesa
“The Loves of Judith” by Meir Shalev
Emanuele Pasquet
Luca Gasparini
Zoë Keating
Mirko Perri
Alessandro Vannucci
Susanna Mastroianni
Vincenza Lamparelli
Pablo Cabello
Mirko Guerra
Claudia Cravotta
Francesca Farneti
Valeria Miranda
Gail Stevens, Rebecca Farhall and Esther King
Thomas Alfandari and Maya Fischer, Roi Kurland and Roni Shamiss
Serena Alfieri
Gian Luca Chiaretti

Iginio Straffi and Alessandro Usai, Marta Donzelli and Gregorio Paonessa
Colorado Film Production and Vivo film with Rai Cinema
Bustan Films
Green Productions
MIC – Direzione Generale Cinema e Audiovisivo
Fandango Sales

Italy
2025
117’
English, Hebrew

Cast

Esther Horwitz	Mili Avital
Yehudit Salomon	Ana Ularu
Zayde Rabinovich	Ori Pfeffer
Moshe Rabinovich	Alban Ukaj
Yaakov Scheinfeld	Marc Rissmann
Globerman	Serhii Kysil
Tonia	Anastasia Doaga
Rivka	Sira Topic
Naomi	Limor Goldstein
Salvatore	Vincenzo Nemolato
Arostam	Menashe Noy
Amos	Moni Moshonov

Synopsis

1970s. Esther, a tormented American in her forties, receives a letter upon the death of her mother: she has to find a woman who lived in the 1930s in Palestine— then under the British Mandate— and who holds a secret about her life. Esther begins her search in Israel helped by Zayde, a university professor with a peculiar past.

1930s. A settlers' village, the atmosphere of a new world. Moshe, a farmer, widower with two children, hires a woman to help him out. The arrival of Yehudit changes the life of Moshe and two other men: Yaakov, a romantic farmer, and Globerman, a cattle trader.

Tying together the threads that bind past and present, Esther and Zayde will discover a shocking truth about their lives.

Director's note

The film revolves around a mystery involving two women, bound by an invisible yet unbreakable thread. One of them, Yehudit, lived in the 1930s in a rural village during the British Mandate for Palestine, where her arrival sparked a bizarre and tangled love story. The other, Esther, is an American with no real connection to the land of her birth, estranged from her family, and drifting through a life without direction.

The storyline set in the 1930s is drawn from a novel by Meir Shalev, one of the most important figures in 20th-century Israeli literature. Esther's investigation, loosely inspired by the book, is instead our own invention. In some ways, it reflects our perspective as Italians - distant from the culture and experience of the young Jews who, at the beginning of the 20th century, left Europe to escape persecution and set out to build a new, egalitarian, and compassionate society. And yet, despite the historical and cultural distance, we found in this story something that speaks deeply to us. Mainly because, like all great stories, it touches on universal themes. Themes that led us on a journey into the many facets of love, revealing how painful, and yet essential, it is to uncover the truth of one's own story.

In the end, Esther and Zayde - having retraced the same path of love, death, and rebirth as their ancestors -

come to understand the importance of engaging with life through empathy, in all its struggles and heartbreak. This is not a political film, and yet the deeper meaning that runs through it is profoundly political: even in the darkest moments of history, people fall in love, build families, form communities, and children are born. And in this perspective, the lines between past and present, and between cultures and peoples, begin to blur, revealing a shared, universal destiny in which it is love that ultimately saves us.

Guido Chiesa

Director's biography

Graduated in Arts and Philosophy, Guido Chiesa began his career in the 1980s working in the U.S. on films by Jim Jarmusch, Amos Poe, and Michael Cimino. His directing credits include *Il caso Martello*, presented at the Venice Film Festival in 1991; *Babylon*, shown at the Locarno Film Festival and winner of the FIPRESCI Award at the Torino Film Festival in 1994; *Johnny the Partisan* (2000) and *Working Slowly (Radio Alice)* (2004), both in competition at the Venice Film Festival; *Quo Vadis, Baby?*, the first original series by Sky Italia; *I am With You* (2010), in competition at the Rome Film Festival; and several successful comedies produced by Colorado Film Production: *Daddy's Boys* (2015), *Let Me Introduce You to Sofia* (2018), and *Say it Loud!* (2020).

Filmography

2025	30 nights with my ex
2025	For the Love of a Woman
2021	Doctor on Call
2020	Say it Loud!
2018	Let me introduce you to Sofia
2017	Class Z
2015	Daddy's Boys
2010	I Am With You
2008	Quo Vadis Baby – TV Series
2007	Adam's Pears - documentary
2004	Working Slowly (Radio Alice)
2000	Johnny The Partisan
	I just can't get enough – documentary with Daniele Vicari
1995	Materiale Resistente – documentary with Davide Ferrario

1994	Babylon
1991	Il caso Martello

The interpreters

Mili Avital – ESTHER

Born in Israel, she made her debut in 1991, winning the Israeli Academy Award for Best Supporting Actress for *Over the Ocean* by Jacob Goldwasser. After moving to the United States, she appeared in films such as *Stargate* by Roland Emmerich and *Dead Man* by Jim Jarmusch. She was one of the leading actors in the acclaimed series *Prisoners of War* (the original inspiration for *Homeland*) and the recent *Kugel*.

Ana Ularu – YEHUDIT

She has worked with some of the most important directors of the Romanian New Wave, including Călin Peter Netzer, Cristian Mungiu, Radu Muntean, and Bogdan George Apetri. Her international film credits include *Youth Without Youth* by Francis Ford Coppola, *Serena* by Susanne Bier, *Inferno* by Ron Howard, and *Siberia* by Matthew Ross, alongside Keanu Reeves. She has also starred in several major TV series, such as *Emerald City*, *Alex Rider*, *Paris Has Fallen*, *Spy/Master*, and *Subteran*.

Ori Pfeffer - ZAYDE

Israeli actor with a long international career. Among his films, Raphaël Nadjari's *Apartment 5C*, Ariel Vromen's *R/X*, Steven Spielberg's *Munich*, Marc Foster's *World War Z*, Mel Gibson's *Hacksaw Ridge* and Martin Campbell's *The Protégé*. He also played in TV Series such as *CSI*, *Alias* and *NYPD Blue*.

Alban Ukaj – MOSHE

Born in Kosovo, he works across both cinema and television and he is one of the most popular and acclaimed Bosnian actors. His credits include *Lorna's Silence* by the Dardenne brothers and *Quo Vadis, Aida?* by Jasmila Zbanic.

Marc Rissmann - YAAKOV

German actor, he played in *The amateur* by James Hawes and, among others, in the series *Game of Thrones*, *1883*, and *The Last Kingdom*.

Serhii Kysil - GLOBERMAN

Ukrainian actor very popular in his home country, particularly for *Diagnosis: Dissent* by Denis Tarasov and TV Series such as *Doktor Kovalchuk* and *Sudya*.

The novel

FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN is loosely inspired by the 1994 novel "The Loves of Judith" by Meir Shalev, who passed away in April 2023, shortly after filming was completed.

Alongside Amos Oz, David Grossman, and A.B. Yehoshua, Shalev is considered one of Israel's most important modern writers. His books have been translated into 26 languages and have received numerous awards, including the Brenner Prize, the Bernstein Award and the National Jewish Book Award.

A television host and author of children's books, Shalev also wrote a weekly column for *Yediot Ahronot*, in which he satirically commented on government politics and the state of Israeli society. A firm supporter of the two-state solution and the return of occupied territories, he believed peace to be impossible with those who continued to advocate for the elimination of the State of Israel as the only solution.